

Project 9

Course Code and Name: MSJ 11342 Public Relation Research

Project Name: The Role of Social Media in Modern Public Relations in Bangladesh

Project Type: Research Paper

Semester of Submission: Summer 2024

Project Description:

The study uses surveys and in-depth interviews with PR practitioners and social media managers to examine social media's impact on PR strategies. It explores communication, audience engagement, and crisis management across platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter. The paper also addresses challenges such as the urban-rural digital divide, misinformation, and limitations of social media in PR.

Project Justification:

The topic was chosen because social media has become central to how organizations in Bangladesh communicate with the public, yet its specific impact on PR strategy in the local context was not fully understood by our group. Researching this helped us apply PR research methodologies, such as survey design, thematic analysis, and sampling techniques, to a real and rapidly evolving communication issue.



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Assignment:

The Role of Social Media in Modern Public Relations (PR) in Bangladesh

Course Title: Public Relation Research

Course Code: MSJ 11342

Section: 01

Submitted to respected faculty

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Title: The Role of Social Media in Modern Public Relations (PR) in Bangladesh

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Focus Area:

The objective of this research is to show how social media has revolutionized public relations (PR) practices in Bangladesh. By examining specific instances within Bangladesh, this analysis dives into how social media influences communication tactics, audience interaction, and reputation management for organizations in the country. Through the analysis of case studies and current trends, this study spotlights the evolution of public relations with the help of social media.

The most important focus of this research is to examine the evolutionary role of social media in Bangladesh, and showcase how organizations with the help of these platforms improve communication, get in contact with mass audiences, and create their public image and manage crises.

1.2 Context:

Bangladesh's use of social networking sites has greatly developed in the last several years. Bangladeshi organizations are using social media sites like Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter to increase their public relations attempts. The goal of this study is to review the reviving of PR techniques in Bangladesh using social media. It also highlights the importance of audience participation, communication, and crisis management.

1.3 Reason behind choosing the topic:

When discussing social media's place in contemporary public relations, we must discuss how social media have utterly transformed the way businesses interact with their target market. It's not these days just about sending out messages, it's also about having discussions, forming connections, and instantly controlling reputation. PR pros can use social media to target a larger audience, and use analytics tools to gauge the success of their initiatives. PR professionals now have an entirely new toolkit at their disposal to engage the public and develop their brand image in the digital era.

Social media has completely changed the public relations landscape globally, and especially in Bangladesh. The extensive utilization of social media platforms has enabled organizations to improve their public relations strategies, guaranteeing their continued relevance and responsiveness in the current digital environment. This study looks into how social media has changed public relations strategies in Bangladesh, emphasizing how it may help with audience engagement, communication, and reputation risk management.

Examining the influence of social media on public relations provides a comprehensive understanding of the ability of internet platforms to influence public opinion.

1.4 The research objective is as follows:

- a) To Examine Social Media Use in Public Relations
- b) To Examine The Effect on Communication Techniques
- c) To Examine Audience Engagement Practices

1.5 The questions that this research will be answering are:

- a) How Bangladeshi are organizations utilizing social media for PR?
- b) What impact has social media had on traditional PR communication strategies in Bangladesh?
- c) In what ways do Bangladeshi organizations engage their audiences through social media?

1.6 Scopes and Limitations of the Research

1.6.1 Scopes:

- a) Increased connectivity

Connecting with a wide and diverse audience: PR professionals use social media as a major tool to connect with their targeted audience.

Instantaneous communication: Instant feedback from the public to the organizations, enhances the relationship between them.

a) Budget friendly

- Cost effective outreach: Compared to traditional media it's a significantly inexpensive way to reach a humongous audience.

b) Crisis Management:

- Quick Response: Social media helps with the rapid distribution of information and management of a crucial public relations crisis.
- Direct Communication: This enables the organizations to directly convey their message to their audiences.

c) Multiple content:

- Multimedia Usage: Multiple content types like (texts, images, videos) makes the PR campaigns more eye-catching and engaging.
- Creative Storytelling: Innovative and visually appealing ways to tell the story of the organization.

1.6.2 Limitations:

a) Digital Divide:

Access Issues: Accessibility of the internet among the population of Bangladesh which can affect the reach of the PR campaigns.

Urban-Rural Disparity: There are day and night differences between the usage of social media between urban and rural areas. Even the social media platform they are more active on might vary.

b) Content Credibility:

Misinformation: Misleading information can affect the credibility of PR campaigns in a negative way. Trust Issues: Due to boulders of false information audiences might have doubts about the authenticity of the information shared on social media.

c) Overload of Information:

Noise and Clutter: The neverending amount of content on social media can challenge the PR message to stand out as much as the organization wants to.

Short Attention Span: According to recent data the attention span of an audience is very less on social media. Which means the PR has to be to the point, short and engaging.

2.0 Literature review:

Research has frequently recognised social media's impact on public relations. According to research done in Bangladesh, social media assists companies engage with audiences effectively, address problems quickly, and continuously manage their public image. But there are also major challenges to overcome, such keeping consistency, responding to negative feedback, and keeping up with the quick changes in social media trends. The literature places an extreme value on social media's strategic plan into PR in order to overcome these issues and maximize social media's potential benefits.

2.1

Title: Social Media Marketing: An Exploratory Analysis on the Emerging Method of Communication

Author: Saadia Shabnam, Afreen Choudhury, and Muhammad Intisar Alam

Journal: World Review of Business Research, Vol. 3, No. 1, January 2013, pp. 1-25

Objectives:

To explore recent trends in social media and its use by marketers.

To understand consumer psychology regarding social media.

To identify the impact of social media on marketing communication and personalized marketing.

Methodology:

Systematic review of literature from 2000 to 2011.

In-depth interviews with marketers from Unilever, Standard Chartered Bank, and Double A Pulp & Paper Company Ltd.

A pilot study with 50 internet users focusing on brand image, association, awareness, loyalty, and consumer experience.

Citation:

Shabnam, S., Choudhury, A., & Alam, M. I. (2013). Social Media Marketing: An Exploratory Analysis on the Emerging Method of Communication. *World Review of Business Research*, 3(1), 1-25.

3.0 Research Design and Methods

We plan on using an online technique that combines a mixed-methods approach to examine the role of social media in modern public relations (PR) in Bangladesh. By using this strategy, Bangladeshi organizations will have an in-depth knowledge of the capabilities, uses, and public relations tactics of social media.

3.1 Research Methodology:

Quantitative Surveys:

Facebook and other social networks are widely active in altering the geography and characteristics of public relations worldwide and offering organizations direct access to the public. In Bangladesh this case social media affects PR strategies to a great extent because it is found that the number of internet users is increasing day by day and people prefer digital communication tools more. This study seeks to gather quantitative data about the concern of the social media adoption and practices as well as the tactics used where the sample will be composed of PR practitioners and organizations in Bangladesh regarding their adoption of social media in PR activities and the perceived impact that they have had on PR.

Research Objectives

To gather valid and consistent information concerning the frequency of the PR practitioners in the context of Bangladesh and their interaction with the social media platforms.

The objective of this research work is to determine the nature of social media that have been widely employed in public relations.

As a technique of research, the following objectives were used in the study in order to assess the performance of social media in crisis management situations.

To determine the extent to which social media affects the execution of public relations plans.

Target respondents: the study will involve communication experts and the target population shall comprise of the following;

Industry experts in the field of Public Relations from different business fields.

Social media managers.

Marketing and brand managers.

Such respondents will be most useful in describing the ways social media is used in PR and the extent to which it aids in the achievement of communication objectives.

Data Collection Methods

Surveys and Questionnaires

The target audience will receive established surveys and questionnaires in order to collect quantitative data. They will record data on: social media regularity and quantity.

Preferred social media sites for public relations initiatives.

Statistics (likes, shares, comments, reach) that are used to measure success and engagement.

Strategies used to control reputation and engage an audience.

Social media handling crisis experiences.

Interviews

Qualitative information will be gathered through in-depth interviews with certain PR professionals and social media managers. These interviews will include the following topics:
Case studies of effective social media efforts.

Barriers to using social media for public relations.

Techniques for controlling public opinion and the reputation of a brand.

Changes to the new technologies and trends in social media.

Sources of Data

The official social media pages of particular organizations will serve as the main sources of data. These pages include:

Facebook: Commonly used for communicating with customers and creating community.

Instagram: Well-liked for brand marketing and visual storytelling.

Twitter: Useful for communicating in real time and during emergencies.

These platforms will offer an extensive collection of data for analysis of content strategies and metrics for participation.

Sampling Method

The technique of purposeful sampling will be used to identify organizations that are already utilizing social media in PR. This method helps in making sure that the particular sample of the study embraces different industries of the organization as well as different sizes of the organization. Still, it is worth noting that this document contains findings from the survey data that will be used to choose specific cases for detailed investigations.

Quantitative Analysis

The collected data shall then be processed in a statistical tool so as to arrive at the necessary trends and patterns. Some basic performance indicators, including website updates' frequency and popularity level, and targeted audience's demographic characteristics, will be assessed to determine the overall effects of social media presence on the probability of achieving PR goals.

Qualitative Analysis

The interviews, which will be carried out with the participants, should be recorded and transcribed further, the performers will analyze data in accordance with the strategies developed for social media using thematic analysis. Coding of qualitative data will help draw insights into. Through the coding of qualitative data the following factors will be extracted.

Audience Engagement: How organizations use social media to interact with their audience, build relationships, and foster community.

Reputation Management: All activities that are used to ensure that the brand image is maintained and where necessary developed, this includes reaction to bad comments and challenging situations.

Content Strategies: The kind of information that is most likely to appeal to the audience and deliver on the Public Relations goals.

Findings and Implications

Thus, the research will contribute to identifying the actual role and utilization of social media in the PR practices in Bangladesh. Key insights are expected to include:Key insights are expected to include:

Effective Platforms: Determination of which social media platform has the most based on various public relations' activities.

Engagement Strategies: Measures that one has to take in order to achieve the highest level of contact with the audience.

Crisis Management: As for the potential role of social media in the case of threat management and assessment, the pre-identified research questions focused on the four model constituents

Strategic Influence: Search for articles to get information on extended consequences of the use of social media on PR strategies and other organizational communications.

It is against this background that this research aims at contributing to the existing body of knowledge on the use of digital communication in PR. Therefore, the present study centered on the dynamics by which the Bangladeshi PR professionals use SM, and the sorts of perception that may build or bar the progress of SM as a tool for PR professionals. The implication of the findings include useful information to PR practitioners in the international organization to enhance the understanding of their social media strategies; and organizations using social media to enhance communication as well as managing negative reputations.

3.2 Sampling:

Quantitative surveys:

Sampling Method: Convenience sampling for the purpose of getting participants from different fields (for example, IT, medical, and sales).

3.3 Data Collection Procedure:

Steps for Data Collection

Step 1: the process of accumulating all the necessary information about the use of social media tools in PR, is to develop an inspiring and persuasive survey.

Demographic Information: Importantly, the participant's poorest score in the PR practice indicators was obtained in the extent of PR experience of the participants: industrial regions, positions held, and years of PR experience of the participants. Those include frequency of use, the platforms that are often used, and the types of content that is shared. Many indicators, including likes, shares, comments, and reach and many others are used to determine level of engagement.

Crisis Management: Explaining how organizations have used or failed to use social media in responding to Public Relations crises.

Overall Influence: The effects of social media on PR results and managerial communication plans.

The survey will be developed in such a way that will be appealing to the eye and with a format that seeks to ensure that as many people as possible fill it.

Step 2: Distributing the Survey

After that, the survey is developed to be followed by the creation of invitations to be sent through several mediums. This includes:

Email Invitations: Direct emails sent to the targeted PR personnel and other communication specialists including the targeted social media managers.

Professional Networks: Advertising the survey through a platform such as LinkedIn since most PR practitioners are active on the said platform.

Social Media Pages: Performing the survey on the social media platform by sharing the survey in the right and active groups, pages, and forums of the same nature.

The invitees will identify why the survey is being conducted, why the respondents' input is valuable, and what the parties stand to gain from responding such as getting an understanding of trends and even benchmarking in the field.

Step 3: Increasing Response Rates

Among the measures included in the survey to increase the response rates, response tracking and follow up reminders will be very important. This involves:

Monitoring Responses: With survey software, one learns who has completed the survey and who has not; making it easier to follow up with defaulters.

Sending Reminders: Periodic follow-up emails of good nature to all the non-respondents that remind them of the usefulness of their feedback and the date when the survey would close.

Final

4.0 Discussion

In Bangladesh, where internet usage and especially an active social media user also increases, these changes have their benefits and some drawbacks. This section aims to discuss the findings

of the study in a more comprehensive way especially on how social media has changed the traditional approaches of communication, enhanced the audience connection and transformed the existing crisis management practices of the organizations in Bangladesh.

Through social media, it has become possible for organizations to advance more timely and engaging means of communicating with their stakeholders thereby incorporating many people into their appeal. This paper reveals that brands in Bangladesh have shifted more reliance on social media, particularly Facebook, YouTube and Instagram, where they not only advertise their products but also build relationships with the buyers. Additionally, these platforms are very interactive hence giving real-time feedback hence making the relationship between the organizations and the audience more engaging.

Another area thus revolutionized by social networks is audience interaction – this is probably one of the major benefits that brands have been given the power over, which grants them an opportunity to nurture a more intimate, emotional relationship with their followers. Through the application of multimedia content, influential spokespersons, and engaging campaigns, the audience engagement has increased making it more of the Participatory model from the PR activity.

Also, as much as social networks are beneficial in managing the crisis it can also have the following disadvantages. On one hand, it has brought an opportunity of responding to negative feelings fast; this has given organizations an opportunity to spread a word around or articulate something before the public gets to know something wrong about them. In contrast, the fast-paced environment of social media can worsen the situation since people's opinions and discussion can become toxic. Hence, this paper concludes by stating that, although great progress has been made within Organizations in Bangladesh in terms of social media responsiveness during crises, the relatively uncontrolled and fast moving nature of the medium poses new issues in managing the narrative.

However, like all research work, it has its limitations and even as the research focuses on how social media has influenced the practice of PR in Bangladesh, it is important to note the

following: First, the study was most orientated to the urban population, especially, those who have regular internet and active accounts in social networks. This can be disadvantageous to those organizations that are located in the rural areas or have not incorporated social media in their PR strategies. However, the study had a limitation in which data collected was self-reported and this brings a bias in the study.

In addition, Surveys and questionnaires were very useful in this research as they gave both quantitative and qualitative results about the perceptions of PR professionals and organizations of Bangladesh about Social Media. Largely, there were demonstrations of the effectiveness of social media for moving to the new level of clients with diverse needs, as well as challenges of controlling brand image and being as genuine as possible. The data gathered from these tools complemented the knowledge between the modernization of PR practices and exposed the trends of business operation particular to the Bangladeshi cultural environment.

In conclusion, it can be depicted that the utilization of social media in the public relations scenario of Bangladesh has become inevitable and significant positively has brought changes in this field of Bangladesh. But as it goes with any digital environment, things are changing constantly and PR specialists have to become even more picky or, in other words, selective in their tactics. However, social media will remain an indispensable tool in the PR arsenal but organizations cannot fail to understand some of the challenges that are inherent from its use as the world becomes a more connected and global village.

4.1 The Evolution of Communication Techniques

Public relations had been changed a lot through the social media ninety degree communication tactic which is used by PR' professionals in Bangladesh. Before, therefore, PR practices in the country were anchored on a trickle-down form of communication where the message was developed and disseminated through newspapers, television and radio. Companies would release their press releases, ads or any statements they wanted the public to know so that it could reach as many people as possible. But the problem associated with them was that these methods did not encourage participation in the sense that the public could merely read the information being circulated. On the other hand, Websites such as Facebook, Instagram and twitter have

transformed the communication environment, permitting both an organization and its audience, a real time two-way communication channel.

Like many other countries of the world, Facebook has today become a focal point to present day PR activities in Bangladesh owing to its huge and dynamic user community. The results of the research showed that due to the vast coverage and more so due to the social aspects of it, the Facebook platform is crucial for any business or organizations to respond to the public. Unlike more conventional means of media, such as broadcasting, the communication received on social media is interactive in the form of comments, likes, shares and direct messages. Businesses can use the opportunity to answer questions that might already have been asked by the audience or address their concerns and provide them with the information they need in a way that will be suitable for them.

Furthermore, Instagram has become quite popular in recent years particularly among the youths because of the aspect of showcasing images. This platform is becoming popular among PR professionals who wish to advance brand stories by making effective use of visuals such as photos, infographics and short clips. This change is indicative of a more extended process, where multimedia content is actually integrated as an ordinary tool in the organization of PR campaigns or substituted the more traditional, text-based methods. The study shows that cuboidal shapes of fonts and brighter and bolder colors are preferred by audiences as such contents are easier to comprehend.

Even if Twitter has less popularity in comparison to Facebook, it is used in some particular situations in Bangladesh such as during the crisis or for updating information timely. Due to its short duration it is widely used to disseminate brief and potent statements in the course of progressing events. For example, when organizations have something urgent to announce to their stakeholders or to comment on a certain event or issue they are concerned with, through Twitter, one is able to post information in a few characters which is brief and a snap to read.

Referring to the study it is observed that these social media platforms are not only being adopted widely by the PR professionals in Bangladesh while they are aware of the fact that the effectiveness of such communication strategies depend entirely upon how well they could modify the strategies in tune with the nature and characteristics of social media. In this context, a

new type of communication is emerging which shares characteristics with the old top-down, one way information broadcasting model but is a two way, real time, continuous exchange of information replacing the top-down conventional heavy handed information dispensing model with a more interactive and exciting new model which provides far greater coverage based on the expectations of the public.

4.2 Audience Engagement Strategies

Social media has made people graduate from mere receivers of PR messages to being active participants in the process. Earlier, the PR campaigns in Bangladesh were mainly about informing a large audience. Now, organizations can engage the audience by asking its members to become a part of the discussion. The scrutiny that comes with social media makes it possible for PR professionals to engage with audiences in directions that could not have been possible with the traditional media.

Sometimes they are referred to as ‘consumer-generated content’ One of the identified strategies in the study is UGC. Undoubtedly, organizations are initiating more and more campaigns where consumers are encouraged to share their testimonials, experiences or extended work based on the brand. Apart from this, it fosters people’s interest in products and services and helps create a community of brand enthusiasts. Audiences also get a sense of belonging when they feel that they are part of the brand’s story, thus having a better connection with the organization. For example, fashion brands operating in Bangladesh are equally effective in conducting hashtag challenges or competitions in which customers use pictures of them wearing the brand’s clothes. This approach targets social proof when people are more convinced by content created by people of their own kind other than media advertisements.

Another key involved in audience development is the consideration of Personalization. Another benefit is that social media networks offer a great amount of information on the target audience’s characteristics and tendencies. These findings could be very relevant to PR professionals as they help them create tailored messages that would be relevant to particular groups of the population. It is far more personal than the mass TYPE of messaging that was typical of traditional PR campaigns. For instance, brands have the opportunity to make ads for Facebook where targeting capability can help deliver specific messages to certain age brackets, geographic regions or

interest sectors. The study also discovered that content that is normally adapted to depict specific users seems to attract enhanced interactivity as it is believed to involve the audiences.

Another social media related PR trend of the last few years is influencer marketing. Most companies operating in Bangladesh are rushing to hire social media personalities who boast of huge followership. These influencers endorse products or services and make them popular as though they use them in their day to day lives. This is especially because influencers usually have one-on-one interactions with their audience who may therefore trust whatever the influencer has to say more than other forms of advertising. This trend is most apparent on Instagram; influencers post custom content to appeal to specific audiences, thus assisting brands in gaining customers' trust.

The study also pointed out that today's organization based in Bangladesh is gradually embarking on the use of shifts like polling, quizzing, live streaming, and Q&A in communicating with their audience. These formats bear significant features of engagement and make the users engage with the brand in real time. This transition from reader-based model to creator-customer model has easily altered the tact PR practitioners have taken regarding the audience, as it shifts the focus from single event, one-off type of communication to continual dialogue.

4.3 Crisis Management and Reputation Control

It has also affected how organizations deal with their publics' especially in crisis situations and shield themselves from negative public images. This is especially the case in today's world where news can go round the globe within a few minutes and one has to know how to handle a crisis. Conventionally, organizations in Bangladesh used to announce their response to a crisis through conventional media only which in many cases was late and had very little coverage. The advancement in social chronological communication has however shifted this environment, where organizations can consequently populate the general public at their own convenience.

As is clear from the study, one of the major revelations is that the real-time nature of social media can be considered as a vital strength when it comes to handling crises. Such an announcement can be just made, corrected or an issue addressed as it unfolds in this year's events such as the release of a public statement on paid parenthood advertisements. Frequently,

this quick response capability helps organizations to respond before the situation deteriorates and take control of the situation. For instance, during the Covid-19 infection virus, various companies and authorities from Bangladesh used social media handles to share updates on health precautionary measures, working status, and guidelines for public safety. Thus, an added advantage was that these organizations could communicate directly with the public and denote transparency and reliability during some difficult times.

However the study also sees the strength of real-time flow of information through social media as having a flip side. As an advantage, it makes it possible for organizations to respond swiftly, but this is on the flip side, bad news or fake news are equally ripple effects speedy. One of the challenges of PR professionals in Bangladesh is handling fake news and rumors that jeopardizes an organization's reputation. The study also noted that once a particular message ideology gets into the public domain, it may take considerable effort and time for the particular organization to reverse their perception despite taking the action. This underscores the need to be ahead and ready when managing crises and or when handling sensitive issues. Companies must have a social media tracking process in place that will help to identify problems and for the company to react to problems as they start.

Credibility is highly valued during calamities and disasters and this is why investors and shareholders should always stick to the truth. The wide audience that engages in social platforms is experienced to identify when an organization is being insincere or trying to dodge responsibility and such an organization is bound to be penalized. The study also found out the fact that the organizations located in Bangladesh who go for the open disclosure culture including the admission of mistakes, explaining about the mishaps and presenting a solution path are more efficacious in managing the reputational risks. On the other hand, when there is a move to stop negative comments or opting out of responsibility, the situation gets worse.

4.4 Limitations of Social Media in PR Practices

However, there are several drawbacks which can be associated with the use of social media platforms in public relations though it is beneficial. This is one of many demanding questions because although youth in cities and other large populated regions are connected to the internet, most of the rural folks, let alone children and adolescents, aren't. However, it is understood that

though more and more emphasis is placed on the use of social networks, there are still many districts with little access to the internet, mostly in the rural areas. For this reason, the campaign is likely to be concentrated in the urban areas leaving out the rural areas thoroughly; this leads to failure in the achievement of the total impact. Businesses that decide to focus on only social media marketing and PR are placing at risk the ability to reach out to the rural people since most of them listen to the radio and watch TV.

Another limitation which can be mentioned is the aspects of credibility. The high production of fake news in the social media platforms remains a big challenge to the PR practitioners to ensure that they get their messages across to the public and such information is deemed relevant by the public. Anyway, it is a known fact that fake news spreads in a couple of minutes, which means that such scientifically proven and based campaigns as the given one can be left behind in a couple of days. Another factor in this regard is that the social media literacy in Bangladesh varies with the age and gender of the users and many users are also trapped into fake news which in turn makes it even more challenging for the PR professional to manage the flow of positive and credible information.

One more crucial issue is informational overload: if people fail to accommodate information of large volumes, instead of an increase or overall number of potential buyers or consumers might decline. The current generation is characterized by social networks which are saturated with information and the PR message is challenged. This has therefore led to the users demanding immediacy, that is, organizations have to come up with information that is short, informative and most importantly attention grabbing. The study also identified that the PR professionals of the present context of Bangladesh are more conscious about shareable content particularly videos, infographics and much more. However, it is a very difficult task to track the creation of social media content at such a fast pace, time consuming, energy and creativity and requires a different set of skills to address the aforementioned challenges.

Based on these findings, it will be important for the PR professionals of Bangladesh to find ways of addressing the new changes in terms of expectations of the audience as well as in emerging

popular social networks. Therefore, by pointing to the opportunities of social media usage that can be utilized in PR while overcoming the listed shortcomings, it is possible to elaborate radical and progressive approaches in organizations to engage as many citizens of the United States of America as possible.

Formulation of Clear and Relevant Research Questions Aligned with the Problem

Development of research questions is one of the most important processes in research as it ensures that once conducting a study, it's coherent, focused and it solves the core problem of the study. In this regard, when the research focuses on how social media has changed the PR practice in Bangladesh, then the research questions must capture the core change that has occurred. Creating these questions calls for an understanding of the problem under study as well as the general purpose of the study in question. The following steps outline the process of formulating research questions that are both clear and aligned with the research problem: The following steps outline the process of formulating research questions that are both clear and aligned with the research problem:

1. Understanding the Problem

The first research question that poses in the present research is as follows: How has social media affected the nature of PR in Bangladesh? It also reveals alterations in the communication approach, the target community, administration of catastrophe in addition to the existing tasks that PR experts encounter in the context of the digital phase. The challenge arises in the need to explain this change, and how organizations in Bangladesh have been able to cope with this change, and they have been able to use the different Social Media platforms to enhance their PR practices.

Key aspects of the problem include:

Communication Shift: With one-way communication like press releases, for example, or TV/Radio advertising to two-way, interactive real-time conversations on social media platforms.

Audience Engagement: The shift of dynamics from message transmission where the audience listens / reads passive to active engagement.

Crisis Management: The pressures for the fast, and timely reactions to the crises in the social media landscape, which society faced and responded to.

Challenges: Challenges including: Disinformation, digital literacy, and the urban-rural disparity impacting the efficiency of sme-based PR campaigns via social media platforms.

Knowledge of these elements is important when developing research questions that address the core concerns more explicitly.

2. Questionnaire

- The next process is to operationalise the research problem and objectives into specific and measurable research questions. These questions have to be precise, which will help to navigate the process of research, while having enough flexibility for one to investigate various aspects of the problem. The research questions should also fall in line with the different aspects of the given problem.
- In what way has the concept of social media modified the processes of communications engaged by the PR organizations in Bangladesh?
- The answer to this question relates to the very essence of the subject by asking how more conventional forms of communication have changed in the context of the digital. To this extent, it aims at identifying how precisely social media has altered the nature of organizational communication with the audience. It keeps the research industry oriented to Bangladesh and investigates the changes that are happening in the PR industry of the location.
- As for the second research question, what part is social media playing in increasing the audience engagement of organizations operating in Bangladesh?
- This question falls squarely within the research objectives focusing as it does on audience engagement. It looks at the multiparty approach to social media and how they encourage

more engagement from the public, ways in which PR professionals utilize tools available in the use of social media including Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter.

- To what extent has social media changed the approach to crisis management among the PR practitioners in Bangladesh?
- Crisis management remains one of the paramount interests of the PR executive especially in today's fast changing global and digital environment. By its turn, this question is more oriented towards how organizations deal with crisis communications and the real-time reputation management in the social media platform. It also includes the analysis of the disinformation management process and the evaluation of the ability to address the public's concerns promptly and properly.
- Which of the following have been identified for Bangladesh's PR profession, as the main challenges and limitations?
- This question relates the challenges of social media within PR. These include fake news, digital literacy and the rural-urban difference. The research can, therefore, present a positive and negative of the use of social media for PR purposes in Bangladesh by discussing these challenges.

3. Alignment with the Problem

The applicability of each of the research questions is evident when compared to the central problem of identifying the transformation of PR through social media in Bangladesh. Analyzing the problem this way, the authors define its major constituents – communication strategies, audiences, crisis, and challenges, to make sure that all the aspects of the transformation occurring in the PR practices are researched.

Thus, the questions are also created in such a way that they permit both qualitative and quantitative analysis. For example, the first and second questions might require the use of cases – actual PR campaigns –observed in Bangladesh while the third question may require interviews with practicing PR practitioners on how to handle crises. The fourth question can elicit qualitative data about student experiences and quantitative information about the rate of such issues as misinformation or the digital gap.

1. Selection of Appropriate Research Design

To select the best research design to increase the chances of the study to meet the research questions and objectives of the study. Based on the research objectives of this study, which is to examine the role of social media in public relations (PR) practice in Bangladesh, a mixed-methods design has been considered most appropriate. Using both quantitative and qualitative research methods in this approach yields a better and more comprehensive finding on the subject.

Quantitative Design: Another method that will be used in the comparative study is a cross-sectional survey; participants will include PR practitioners, social media managers, and communication specialists in different organizations in Bangladesh. This method enables the gathering of quantitative data on the extent, frequency and approaches used in social media by PR. This will be useful in the overall understanding of trends, practices, and the probability of social media on PR.

Qualitative Design: Survey data will be supplemented with in-depth interviews and case studies. In this interview, participants will include PR practitioners and social media managers to understand from them and their experience, and perhaps, their perception of how this social media has impacted on the practice of PR. The qualitative data will present an enriched view of the pattern and issues of PR practices, audiences, and crisis management.

This mode of research design is appropriate in this case due to the following reasons: Quantitative study provides a wide coverage to generalize findings, while qualitative study provides detailed information. In this sense, it contributes both to the objective evaluation of the use of social media and the qualitative characterization of experiences in the field. Through this design, the study will be able to capture the nuances of how Social Media is affecting PR practice in Bangladesh.

2. Comprehensive Discussion of Ethical Considerations

- Ethical standards and Research Ethics is of utmost importance in case of human subject research. Several ethical considerations will guide this study: Several ethical considerations will guide this study:

- **Informed Consent:** Anonymous respondents conducting questionnaires or interviews of the study will be provided notice of the objectives of the research, the proposed use of the data and the respondent's rights. Available consent forms will be given and participating subjects will be reminded that they are free to pull out of the study at any one time without being held to account.
- **Confidentiality and Anonymity:** It is very important to respect the rights of the participants, especially the rights to privacy. Participants' information will be collected and used for research purposes only, the information such as names of the participants, their organizations or their positions within their organizations will be disguised in order to maintain participants' privacy. It also helps to allow the participants to be absolutely honest with their answers without having to worry about the consequences which may be professional or even personal.
- **Data Security:** All the data that will be collected through the surveys or interviews shall be properly kept. The new digital data will be encrypted and only limited to those people who have been allowed to get access. This goes a long way in ensuring that only the right people have access to information or prevent information leakage.
- **Avoidance of Harm:** The research will endeavor to ensure that there are no complications to anyone using the services, in the process of providing the above services. Controversial issues including managing public relations crises shall also be handled carefully so that the interviewees feel uncomfortable answering those questions. Participants will be made comfortable throughout the process of the interviews and they can do away with any question that may cause discomfort.
- **Transparency and Integrity:** Concerning data dissemination, participants in the study shall be informed about the purpose of the study, how the results of the study will be disseminated and where to obtain the results in case they show interest will be explained to them. The research will be free from dishonest and inaccurate data manipulation and fabrication as per the whims of the research.

3. Relevant Support of Previous Literature

- This research extends the body of literature on social media effect on public relations and communication management. Several previous studies provide a foundation for this

research, demonstrating both the global trends and local adaptations of social media in PR: Several previous studies provide a foundation for this research, demonstrating both the global trends and local adaptations of social media in PR:

- Global Research on Social Media and PR: Some of the current works like Shabnam et al 'Social Media Marketing: An Exploratory Analysis on the Emerging Method of Communication', have underlined the importance of social media in today's marketing and public relation strategies. They stress on the fact that social networks offer an arena for audience interaction, this research focuses on a similar phenomenon taking place in Bangladesh. From being a one-way, information-subscription process followed by organizations to an interactive two-way communication process between the organizations and their publics, is a major theme that this research will seek to establish for the Bangladeshi Setting.
- Bangladesh-Specific Studies: For instance, Khan et al. 's (2019) empirical research, which is titled, "The Impact of Social Media on Corporate Communication: Evidence from Bangladesh" indicates that local actors are embracing such platforms as Facebook, Instagram, and Twitter to communicate with their audience. Thus, there are still obstacles like misperceptions and the technological gap in front of the person. These studies give pivotal information and data about the exact cultural and technological factors that affect the use of social media in PR in Bangladesh. This research aims to build on by finding out the effects of audience engagement and development of effective crisis management in the use of social media in PR in Bangladesh.
- Crisis Management Literature: Having highlighted the use of social media in the management of PR crises let us now discuss the same in relation to global literature. For example, using Coombs' SCCT (2014) on 'Situational Crisis Communication Theory', it is possible to analyze how the organizations in the Bangladeshi context can potentially manage such conditions as misinformation and negativity in social media.

Thus, the research is based on the existing literature and is developing novel findings particularly relevant to the setting of Bangladesh. Using global PR frameworks and local business case

studies makes it possible to understand how social media is disrupting the PR practice in this context.

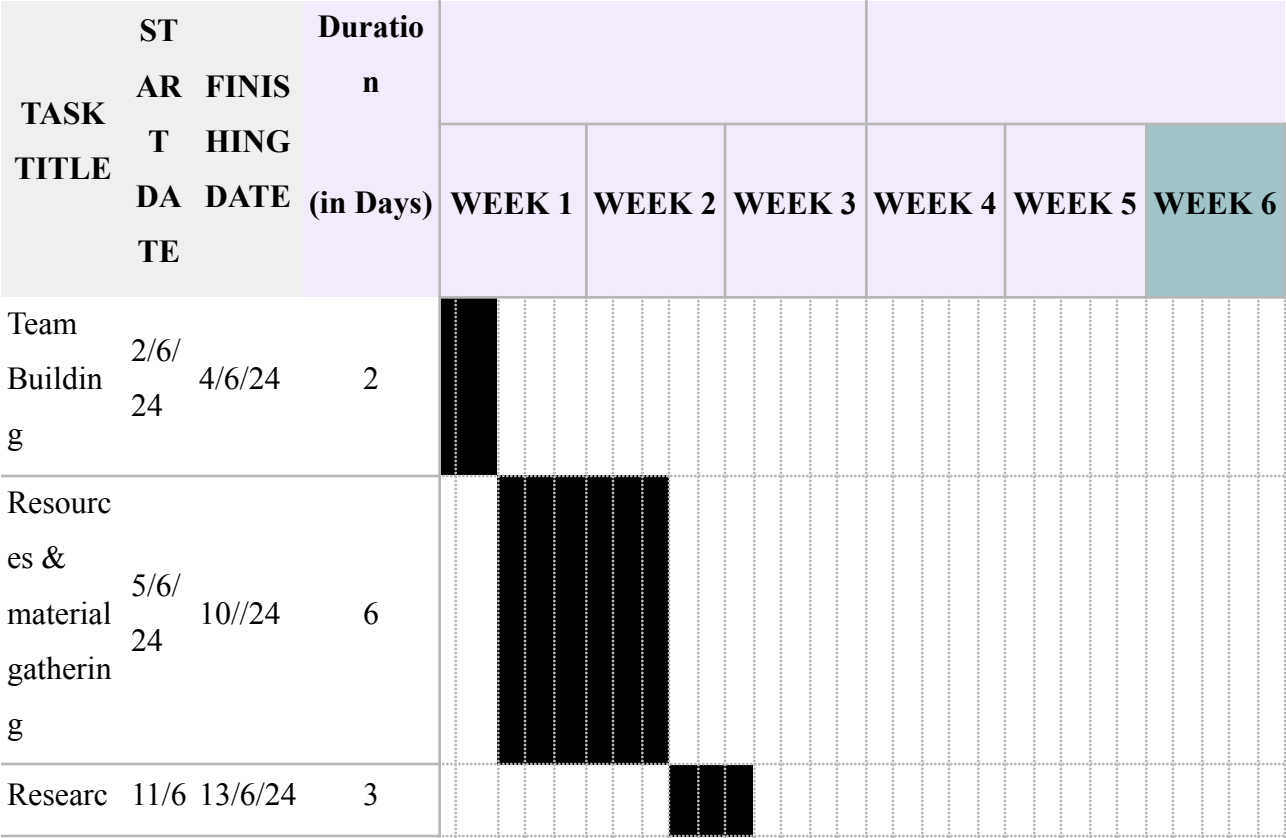
Conclusion

Going with the findings and the details presented in the research paper, there is substantial evidence that Social media has positively impacted PR in Bangladesh and in practice. Since social media platforms such as Facebook, Instagram and twitter are now central to communication, business and PR professionals benefit from a wider and diverse clientele. The transition from mass communication one way to two way real time has shifted the communication paradigm and has proven to be beneficial to the companies by strengthening the relation with their stakeholders, facilitating the brand interaction and managing crisis. But this digital revolution has also brought problems with it, for instance, urban rural digital disparity, validity of contents, fake news, and excessive deflection of information.

Nevertheless, it is clear that social media cannot be ignored in the process of spreading information and that PR practitioners need to incorporate effective tactics to work effectively in the new environment created by the development of the Internet. It highlights the possibilities of using user generated content, influencer marketing, and personalization as primary engagement approaches. Besides, the study shows that organizations need to fully disclose the information and constantly engage stakeholders in crisis communication in order to portray a good image and gain public trust.

Therefore the following studies concluded that though social media has undoubtedly transformed the dynamics of PR practices in Bangladesh, the adoption of this new platform also requires a proper PR strategy that focuses on the positive usage and minimizes the negative effects. This means as the digital trends go on, PR practitioners must embrace change, act proactively in controlling image, and must also be sensitive with the ever changing needs of the market. Consequently, social media is not only a communication tool but an integral part of modern public relations which will shape the direction of the future in Bangladesh

Gantt Chart



[illegible]

TASK TITLE	START DATE	FINISHING DATE	Duration (in Days)						
				WEEK 7	WEEK 8	WEEK 9	WEEK 10	WEEK 11	WEEK 12
Data Analysis	18/08/24	20/08/24	2						
Ethical Considerations	21/08/24	27/08/24	6						
Discussion	28/08/24	31/09/24	3						

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Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- I learnt how social media has transformed PR in Bangladesh.
- I learnt the importance of audience engagement in modern PR.
- I learnt that social media is important for crisis and reputation management.